

Holocron — Discovery Signal Pack

Day 2 handout. The customer signal gathered for the Holocron project — interview notes, support-ticket patterns, observations, and indirect signal — pooled for your discovery. Use it in **Activity 1 (Compressed Customer Discovery)** to ground your persona, name the top pains, and trace the journey friction. This is a **starting set**: it is real signal on record, but it is not complete — validate and extend it with the stakeholders named in the problem brief. Do not invent beyond what's here or what you confirm firsthand.

Direct customer signal

Interviews, support tickets, observation, and usage data — organized by role.

Content Owner — owns the UI text, blocked behind engineering today

- *"A one-word fix to a legal disclaimer is a ticket, an engineering sprint slot, a review, and a release. It's live two weeks later."*
- *"When Legal asks me 'who approved this, and when?', I'm digging through old email — there's no record I can point to."*
- **Observation:** content teams keep a running "text changes waiting on engineering" list; some items have sat more than 30 days.
- **Ticket pattern:** recurring weekly "please update the copy on screen X" requests — none of them require technical judgment.

Engineer (consuming application) — integrates the rendered text, wants to stop hardcoding

- *"Every app hardcodes its own strings. When a standard changes, we retrofit dozens of apps by hand."*
- *"I get pulled off feature work to change a button label — it's the lowest-value interrupt I have."*
- *"There's no shared way to fetch strings, so each team reinvents string loading."*

Legal / Compliance reviewer — must approve compliance-sensitive text

- *"Strings ship without us seeing them. We find out a disclaimer is wrong after it's already in production."*
- *"Approval evidence is scattered across email and chat — I can't produce a durable, centralized record for an audit."*
- **Data point:** several past releases with legally sensitive wording had no recorded review gate.

Translator / vendor — produces locale content through file exchange

- *"There's no single source of truth, so the same term gets translated three different ways across products."*
- *"We work off exchange files; when the source string changes after we start, we end up translating text that's already stale."*

Architecture / Review Administrator — governance and routing

- *"Without key and namespace governance, changing a shared string cascades in ways nobody predicts."*
- *"Review requests land on a generic admin inbox — there's no way to route them to the right authorized reviewer."*

Indirect signal

Public/observed signal, internal chatter, and patterns.

- **Internal Slack:** recurring threads — *"who owns this string?"* and *"can someone push a copy change for me?"*
- **Improvised tooling:** teams have worked around the gap with spreadsheets, per-app text files, and one-off admin

scripts — a clear sign of unmet demand.

- **Compounding debt:** every new application still ships with hardcoded strings, so the future retrofit burden keeps growing.

What's missing — confirm with stakeholders

These are genuinely open. Name them; don't paper over them.
(They mirror the open questions in the problem brief.)

- How fast a published change must reach consuming applications (propagation target).
- The peak demand the delivery mechanism must sustain.
- Whether — and how — right-to-left (RTL) languages are in scope for this version.
- How shared/reused terminology is governed across products (the master-data / reference-data operating model).
- How success and value will be measured for the governance and rollback capabilities.

How to use this in Activity 1

1. **Pool** these into your Day-2 buckets: **Direct signal**, **Indirect signal**, **What's missing** — adding anything you confirm firsthand with the real stakeholders.
2. **Name the persona** — the one role whose pain anchors your release (start from the Content Owner unless your evidence points elsewhere).
3. **Rank the top 3 pains** (severity × frequency × addressability) and trace the **journey friction** — where the current process breaks down.
4. Carry the result into your **discovery summary**, which feeds PRD-light Sections 1–2.

The rule still holds: ground every claim in this signal or in a source you confirm — do not invent customer signal.